

BETELEHEMU

3

for S.A.T.B. voices with percussion

AFRICAN FOLK TUNE

Transcribed by

JONATHAN CRUTCHFIELD

YOURUBA FOLK TEXT

Accented and slow $\text{♩} = 72$ SOPRANO
ALTOTENOR
BASS

Be - te - le - he - mu.

Be - te - le - he - mu.

5

A - wa _____ yi yo _____ ri

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

9

Ba - ba _____ gbo - ju - le.

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

13

A - wa _____ yi yo _____ ri

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

17

Ba - ba _____ fe - hin - ti.

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

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21 2.

(ti.)

mu. Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

26 $\text{♩} = 75$

(Bongos) (Add Long Drum and High Conga) (Add Low Conga and Shaker) (Add Cowbell)

Percussion soli

30 ♩

A - wa yo ri Ba - ba gbo - ju - le, A - wa yo ri Ba - ba fe - hin - ti.

Upper notes optional, only on repeat.

32

Ni - bo la - be, Je - su. —

Ni - bo la - be, Je - su. — Ni - bo la - be bi - i. —

Ni - bo la - be, Ni - bo la - be, Ni - bo la - be, ni - bo la - be,

34

Be - te - le - he - mu Il - u a - yo, Ni - bo la - be Ba - ba o da - ju.

36 *fp*

Be - te - le - he - mu ll - u a - yo, Ni - bo la - be Ba - ba o da - ju.

39 *f*

Yeen, Yeen, Yeen Yeen Ba - ba lo.

43

go. A du - pe fu o. A du - pe fu o. A du - pe fu

49

o lo jo - o - ni, Ba - ba o lo re - o. Fi yeen fo lu -

54

wa. Fi yeen fo lu - wa. Fi yeen fo lu - wa lo jo - o - ni,

59

Ba - ba to da wa si.

64 **Tempo I°**

Tenor or Soprano solo

Repeat 4 times

A-wa— yi yo

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

68

Ba - ba Gbo - ju - le, A-wa— yi yo

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

72

D.S. al Coda

Ba - ba fe - hin - ti. Repeat 3 times

Repeat 4 times. Accel. 4th time.

Be - te - le - he - mu. Be - te - le - he - mu.

Coda

76

Ni-bo la - be Ba-ba o da-ju.

BETELEHEMU

Percussion Parts

7

The musical score is written for six percussion instruments: Bongos, High Conga, Low Conga, Shaker/Tambourine, Log Drum, and Cowbell. The time signature is 12/8, indicated by a double bar line, a '12' above the staff, and an '8' below. The score is organized into six staves, each with its instrument name to the left. The Bongos part features a continuous eighth-note pattern with accents. The High Conga part has a similar eighth-note pattern with occasional eighth rests. The Low Conga part plays a more sparse pattern with eighth notes and eighth rests. The Shaker/Tambourine part consists of a steady eighth-note accompaniment. The Log Drum part has a sparse pattern with half notes and eighth notes. The Cowbell part follows a similar eighth-note pattern to the Bongos. Each staff ends with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

BONGOS

HIGH CONGA

LOW CONGA

SHAKER/
TAMBOURINE

LOG DRUM

COWBELL

We are glad that we have a Father to trust.
 We are glad that we have a Father to rely upon.
 Where was Jesus born?
 In Bethlehem, the city of wonder.
 That is where the Father was born for sure
 Praise be to Him.
 We thank you for this day, gracious Father.
 Praise be to You, merciful Father.

Pronunciation guide (...in order of appearance)

Betelehemu	be-teh-leh-heh-moo
Awa	ah-wah
yi	ee
yo	yoh
ri	ree
Baba	bah-bah
Gbojule	boh-joo-leh (g is silent)
fehinti	feh-heen-tee
Nibo	nee-boh
laa	lah
bi	bee
Jesu	yeh-zoo
Ilu	Ee-loo
ayo	ah-yoh
o	oh
daju	dah-joo (hard "j")
yeen	yeen
lo	loh
go	goh
A	ah
dupe	doo-peh
fu	foo
jooni	joh-oh-nee
re	reh
fi	fee
fo	foh
luwa	loo-wah
to	toh
da	dah
wa	wah
si	see
bi	bee